Chapter 1

The Thirsty Crow

It was a hot summer afternoon. The sun was shining brightly and the ground was dry and cracked. A small black crow had been flying for a long time. He was very thirsty, and his throat felt dry and rough.

The crow looked everywhere for water. He flew over the fields, but the ponds had dried up. He flew over the village, but every well was covered with a lid. "If I do not find water soon, I will faint," he said to himself.

At last, he saw a clay pot under a neem tree in a garden. He flew down happily and looked inside. There was some water in the pot, but it was at the very bottom. The crow pushed his beak into the pot, but his beak could not reach the water. He tried again and again, but it was no use. The pot was too heavy for him to tip over.

The crow did not give up. He sat on the edge of the pot and began to think. "There must be a way," he said. Then he noticed a heap of small pebbles lying near the pot.

The crow had a clever idea. He picked up one pebble in his beak and dropped it into the pot. Plop! Then he dropped another pebble, and another. Each pebble pushed the water up a little higher.

The crow worked patiently for a long time. Slowly, the water rose to the top of the pot. At last, he could reach it easily with his beak. He drank the cool water until he was no longer thirsty. Then he flew away happily, cawing loudly.

What the story teaches us

The crow was clever because he used his mind when he could not use his strength. He was also patient, because he dropped the pebbles one by one and did not give up. The lesson of the story is: where there is a will, there is a way.

Let's talk

1. Why was the crow thirsty?
2. Why could the crow not drink the water at first?
3. How did the pebbles help the crow?
4. Can you think of a time when you solved a problem by thinking carefully?

New words

pebble - a small, smooth stone
patient - able to wait calmly without getting upset
faint - to fall down suddenly because you feel very weak